



— FREE OWNER'S GUIDE

Statement Analysis Checklist

Go through your card processing statement line by line and find out what you're really paying, whoever your processor is.

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- Find your effective rate
 - Fee-by-fee checklist
 - Questions to ask your processor
 - The three parts of every card fee
 - Red flags to circle
 - How to get a free review

STEP 1

Find your effective rate

Processors name their fees differently, so comparing fee names gets you nowhere. One number cuts through all of it: your **effective rate**, meaning total fees as a share of total card sales. Take both numbers from the summary section of the same monthly statement.

Total card sales this month

Total fees this month (every line)

Effective rate = fees ÷ sales × 100

Do this for three months in a row. One month can be thrown off by an annual fee or an unusual week, but three months shows the real pattern.

STEP 2

Know the three parts of every card fee

1. Interchange

Set by the card networks and paid to the bank that issued the card. It changes with the card type (debit, rewards, business) and how it was taken (tapped, dipped, keyed).

2. Network fees

Charged by Visa, Mastercard, Discover and American Express on your volume and transactions. Often labeled "assessments."

3. Processor markup

What your processor adds on top.
This is the part that differs between processors, and the part you can change.

How your markup is packaged

PRICING MODEL	WHAT YOU'LL SEE	WHY IT MATTERS
Interchange-plus	Interchange passed through, plus a listed markup	Easiest to audit: the markup is shown on its own.
Tiered	"Qualified", "mid-qualified" and "non-qualified" rates	The processor decides which transactions land in the higher tiers.
Flat rate	One percentage (plus a per-sale amount) on every card	Predictable, and simple to check against your deposits.

STEP 3

Fee-by-fee checklist

Tick each fee you find, and write down what it cost you this month. Circle any line you can't explain.

FEE	WHAT IT IS	FOUND?	THIS MONTH
Discount rate / markup	The percentage charged on your card sales	☐ yes ☐ no	
Per-transaction fee	A flat amount charged on every sale, sometimes called an authorization fee	☐ yes ☐ no	
Monthly or statement fee	A charge just for having the account or for the statement itself	☐ yes ☐ no	
PCI compliance fee	A charge tied to card security requirements	☐ yes ☐ no	
PCI non-compliance fee	An extra charge if a yearly security questionnaire wasn't completed	☐ yes ☐ no	
Batch / settlement fee	Charged each time the day's sales are closed out and sent for funding	☐ yes ☐ no	
Gateway fee	For online or integrated payments	☐ yes ☐ no	
Annual fee	Often appears once a year, so check every month's statement	☐ yes ☐ no	
Monthly minimum	A top-up charged when your fees fall below a set amount	☐ yes ☐ no	
Chargeback fee	Charged when a customer disputes a sale	☐ yes ☐ no	
Equipment lease	Monthly payment on terminals. Check the length of the lease and whether you can cancel it	☐ yes ☐ no	
Mid / non-qualified surcharges	Extra charges on tiered pricing for "downgraded" cards	☐ yes ☐ no	
Early termination fee	Not on the statement: it's in your contract. Find out whether you have one and what it is	☐ yes ☐ no	
Total of the fees above			

— STEP 4

Red flags to circle

- ☐ Your effective rate went up, but your card mix and sales didn't change.
- ☐ A fee appeared that wasn't there last month, or one got bigger without a notice you remember.
- ☐ Lines you can't match to anything in your agreement.
- ☐ A large share of sales billed at "mid-qualified" or "non-qualified" rates.
- ☐ A PCI non-compliance fee month after month.
- ☐ An equipment lease that costs more over its term than the equipment is worth, or that you can't cancel.
- ☐ Charges for services you don't use, such as a gateway when you only take cards in person.

— STEP 5

Questions to ask your processor

- ☐ What pricing model am I on: interchange-plus, tiered or flat?
- ☐ What exactly is your markup, as a percentage and per transaction?
- ☐ Can you walk me through every fee on this statement, one line at a time?
- ☐ Which fees can change, and how much notice do you give?
- ☐ Do I have an early termination fee or an equipment lease, and when does each end?
- ☐ When does my money land in my account after I close the day?

Notes from the call

— NEXT STEP

Compare it with EPAY POS

Once you know your effective rate, set it against EPAY POS's two options:

— FLAT RATE

2.3% + 5¢

One flat rate on every card. No tiered surprises.

— CONSUMER CHOICE

0%

Card-paying customers cover the processing cost.

Batches settle to your account the next business day.

Get a free, line-by-line review

Send us your latest statement and we'll go through every fee with you. No obligation, no sales pressure. You'll see exactly what you're paying and what you'd pay with us.

Upload it: epaypos.net/offers/statement-review

Call: 947-228-7226, ext. 3 for sales

Visit: 185 E Big Beaver Rd, Troy, MI 48083

This checklist is general guidance, not financial or legal advice. Fee names and terms vary by processor, so check your own agreement. © EPAY POS.